

INSY7311

Assignment 2

Angelo Ritumalta

ST10078206

Group 2

15 April 2026

Table of Contents

Introduction:	3
1. Short Explanation on Feedback received:	3
2. Low-Fidelity Prototype.....	4
3. Evaluation Plan	10
4. Evaluation Methods	11
Reference List:	14

Introduction:

The *Student Quest* is designed to connect students with short-term jobs and opportunities in a simple, efficient, and secure manner. The application allows users to browse available quests, apply for jobs and communicate through messages while being fully secure all within a single platform. The primary goal of the application is to provide a user-friendly and secure experience that allows students to easily find jobs without having to worry about payment or safety.

1. Short Explanation on Feedback received:

In Assignment 2, the low-fidelity prototype was improved based on the feedback received from assignment 1 and the design principles covered in learning unit 6. The feedback from Assignment 1 was that the language, editing, and referencing must be up to standard. This meant adding a well-typed introduction as well as writing the report from third person point of view. The feedback received from the design of the low-fidelity prototype was that full marks would only be given if the design principles were clearly shown in the prototype. So, to implement this into assignment 2, the low-fidelity prototype has now added another five design principals to not only adhere to the feedback but also to improve user experience. The five design principles implemented were visual hierarchy, alignment, proximity, contrast, and simplicity which will later be discussed in this report.

2. Low-Fidelity Prototype

Visual Hierarchy:

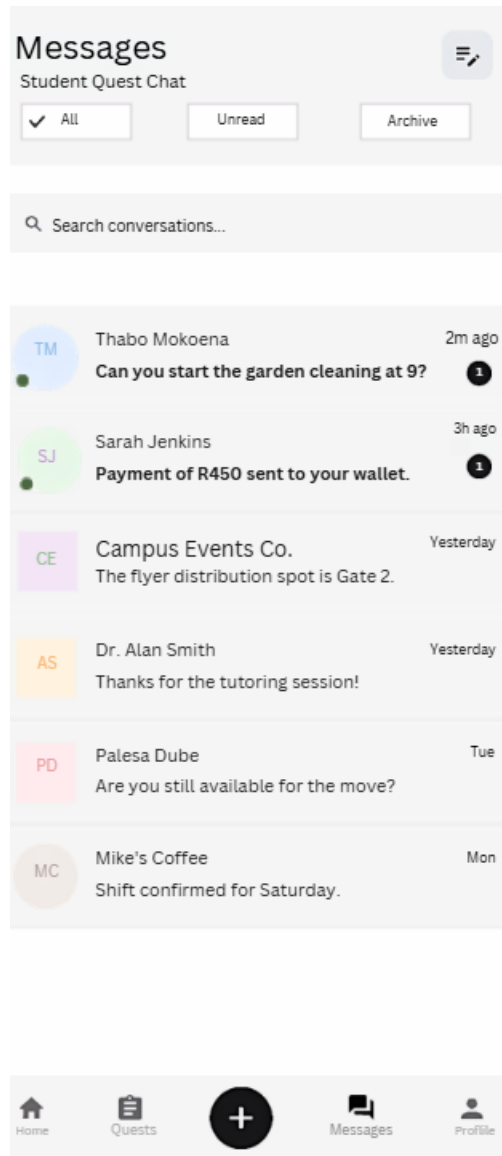


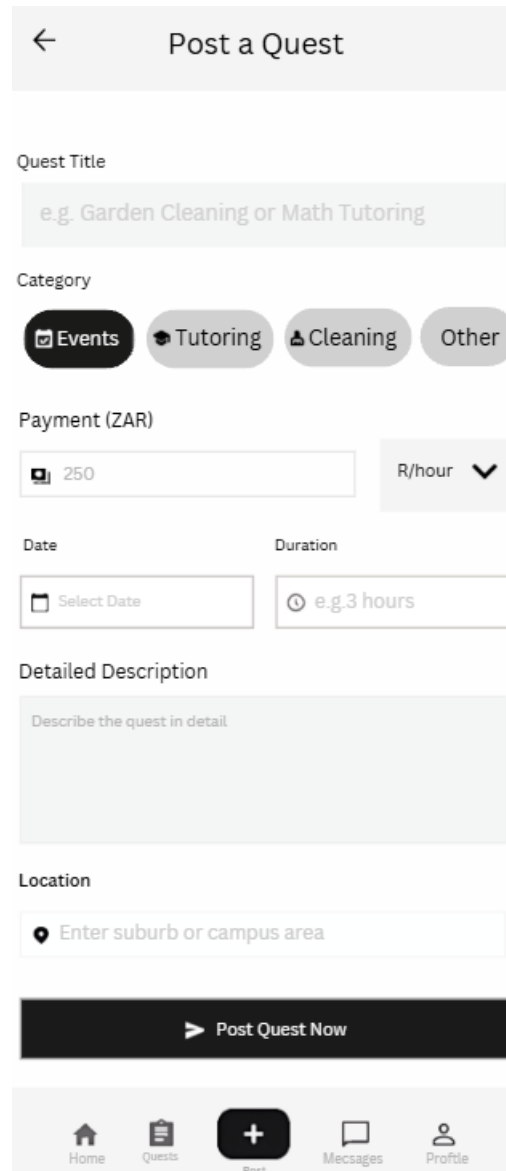
Figure 1 Messages Screen

Principle: Visual Hierarchy

Reason: Visual Hierarchy is the arranging and emphasizing components/elements so that users can notice the important information easier and quicker. This can be achieved by using different colors, fonts, font sizes etc. This has been added to the messages screen by first adding a small circle with a

number placed inside of it to indicate that the user has unread messages, and the number indicates how many unread messages in that chat they have. The second way the principle was added was by making the text in the unread message chat bold to also indicate to the user that they have unread messages. This gets the users attention easier in a modern and clean way.

Simplicity:



The image shows a mobile app screen titled "Post a Quest". At the top is a navigation bar with a back arrow and the title "Post a Quest". Below this is a "Quest Title" section with a text input field containing the placeholder "e.g. Garden Cleaning or Math Tutoring". The "Category" section features four buttons: "Events" (with a calendar icon), "Tutoring" (with a graduation cap icon), "Cleaning" (with a broom icon), and "Other". The "Payment (ZAR)" section includes a text input field with "250" and a dropdown menu set to "R/hour". Below these are two more input fields: "Date" with a "Select Date" placeholder and "Duration" with an "e.g. 3 hours" placeholder. A large text area for "Detailed Description" has the placeholder "Describe the quest in detail". The "Location" section has a text input field with a location pin icon and the placeholder "Enter suburb or campus area". A prominent black button with a white right-pointing arrow and the text "Post Quest Now" is located below the location field. At the bottom is a navigation bar with five icons: "Home" (house), "Quests" (list), "Post" (plus sign), "Messages" (speech bubble), and "Profile" (person).

Figure 2 Post a Quest Screen

Principle: Simplicity

Reason: Simplicity refers to how simple the interface is to the user. Simplicity should avoid unnecessary difficulties for the user and reduce cognitive load. Simplicity has been added to this screen by having hints shown in grey text in the text boxes so that the user is not confused where to type and helps them identify what to type. For example, the Title bar gives the user an example of what to type in the textbox. These hints help reduce cognitive load and help make it easier for the user.

Proximity:

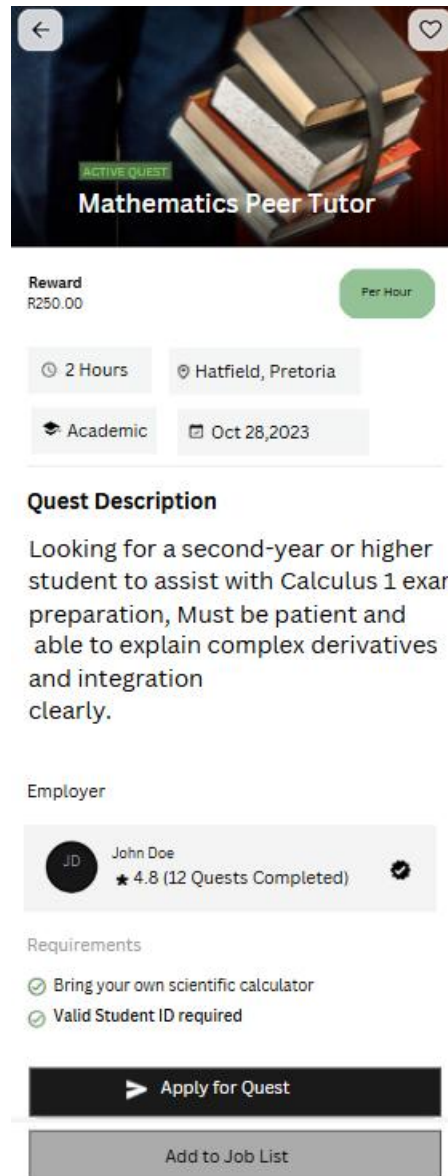


Figure 3 Apply for Quest Screen

Principle: Proximity

Reason: Proximity is the placement of related elements/components close together to help show their relationship. For example, if you look at a shopping app, The add to cart and add to Wishlist will always most likely be next to each other or close by. I have applied this same concept. I have added my “Add to Job List” button below the “Apply for Quest” button. This is to show their relationship and provide convenience for users.

Contrast:

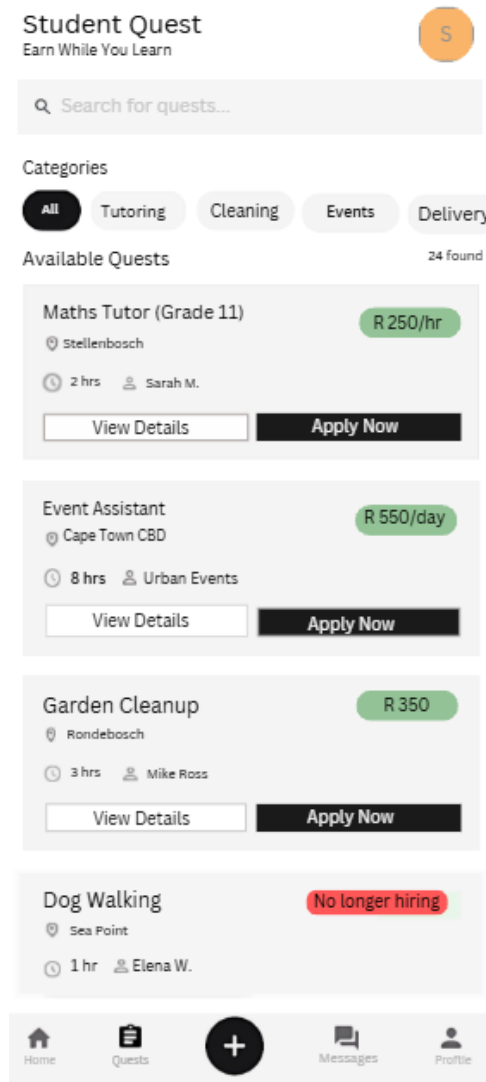


Figure 4 Quests Screen

Principle: Contrast

Reason: Contrast helps show the different elements/components and highlights important information. This can be achieved by having different colors, changing sizes of elements etc. Contrast is included in this page by changing the green bubble to red if a job is no longer available. Once a job is no longer available, the user will no longer see the “View Details” or the “Apply Now” button. This also avoids users having to waste time looking at jobs that are no longer available.

Alignment:

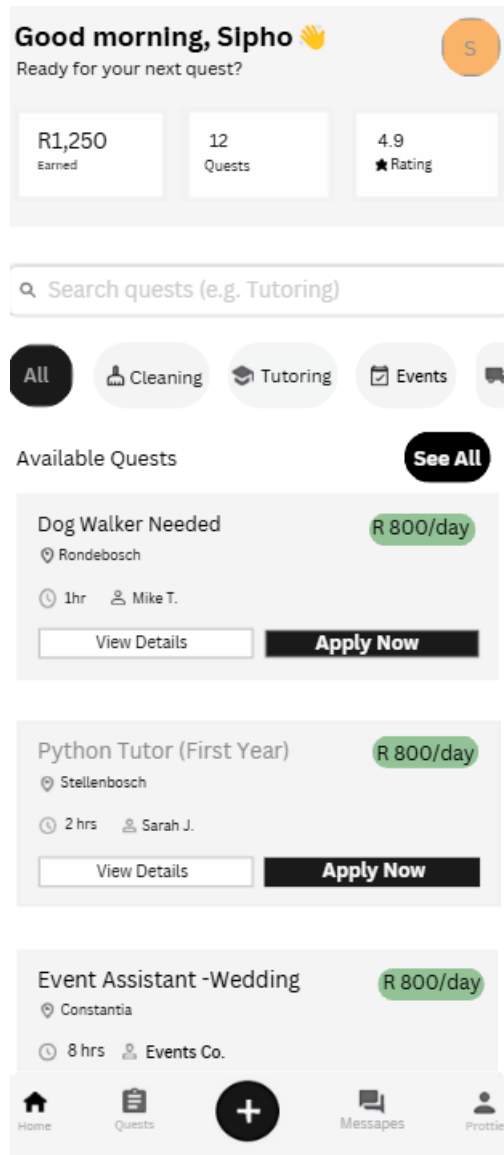


Figure 5 Home Screen

Principle: Alignment

Reason: Alignments refer to elements/components lining up consistently. This not only helps make the interface look neat and has a clean layout but also helps with readability, reduces clutter, and creates a constant order of things. Alignment is applied to this screen by having each job card spaced evenly and having a white gap between to show separation. Alight is also shown for the “View Details” or the “Apply Now” button. Another alignment would be the category bubbles are evenly spaced out. All this creates a neat layout which helps readability and improves user experience.

3. Evaluation Plan

An Evaluation Plan is a continuous activity throughout the design lifecycle. This tests and assesses how well a system works in terms of usability and user experience. The goal is to identify design problems and make the necessary improvements. The evaluations that have been chosen are Field Testing (Usability Tests), Heuristic Evaluation (Expert Reviews), and Cognitive Walkthrough (Expert Reviews). These methods were selected to ensure that both user-based and expert-based evaluations are conducted to provide a comprehensive assessment of the application's user interface.

4. Evaluation Methods

Field Testing

Definition:

Field testing forms part of the Usability Tests evaluation. This involves users interacting with the application in a real world setting such as offices, universities, homes, etc. This to identify usability issues. For this project, the ideal setting would be universities as the target users would be university students.

Motivation:

This method is important because it is in a real word setting and involves real-time interactions with users to get their immediate feedback. This provides insight into how users (students) interact with the app and helps reveal issues that the designer may have overlooked while creating the app.

Implementation:

To implement this method, a group of students will be asked to perform tasks using the app such as adding a job, navigating through messages, browsing available jobs, etc. Students interacting will be monitored and recorded. This will help identify any problems and areas for improvement.

Heuristic Evaluation

Definition:

Heuristic Evaluation forms part of the Expert Reviews. This method is where experts evaluate a system based on the usability principles such as consistency, simplicity, and visibility.

Motivation:

This method is effective because it is fast and structured, widely used in the industry, and helps identify the usability issues without requiring a large number of users. This helps the system follow the best practices.

Implementation:

To implement this method, experts will review the application (Student Quest) and evaluate it against usability principles. These principles include:

- Consistency
- Visibility
- Simplicity

Anything that does not align with these principles will be documented, and improvement will be made accordingly.

Cognitive Walkthrough:

Definition:

A Cognitive Walkthrough is an evaluation method where experts simulate user's problem-solving process step-by-step to assess how easy it is for the user to use the system.

Motivation:

This method is useful for evaluating learnability, which plays a key role in user experience. It focuses on how easily users can understand how to complete tasks and navigate through the app without having experience of using the app before.

Implementation:

Experts will simulate a new user interacting with Student Quest by going through tasks step-by-step.

Tasks such as:

- Posting a quest
- Messaging
- Applying for a job

At each step, the expert will ask questions such as:

- Will the user know what to do?
- Will they notice the correct action?
- Will they understand the feedback?

Any issues will be documented and will be used to make the necessary improvements to the design.

Reference List:

1. Rogers, Y., Sharp, H. and Preece, J. (2023). *Interaction Design: Beyond human-computer interaction*. 6th ed. John Wiley & Sons. [Accessed 13 April. 2026]
2. Agoni, A.E. (n.d.). *INSY7311 Learning Unit 6: Visual Design and Design issues*. [Accessed 13 April. 2026]
3. Agoni, A.E. (n.d.). *INSY7311 Learning Unit 7: Evaluation and Usability Testing*. [Accessed 13 April. 2026]
4. Figma. (2025). *13 Graphic Design Principles + How To Apply Them | Figma*. [online] Available at: <https://www.figma.com/resource-library/graphic-design-principles/> [Accessed 14 Apr. 2026].
5. Gordon, K. (2020). *5 Principles of Visual-Design in UX*. [online] Nielsen Norman Group. Available at: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/principles-visual-design/> [Accessed 14 Apr. 2026].